

Making Places and Creating Destinations in Lancaster County



**Presented by
Lancaster County Planning Commission Staff**

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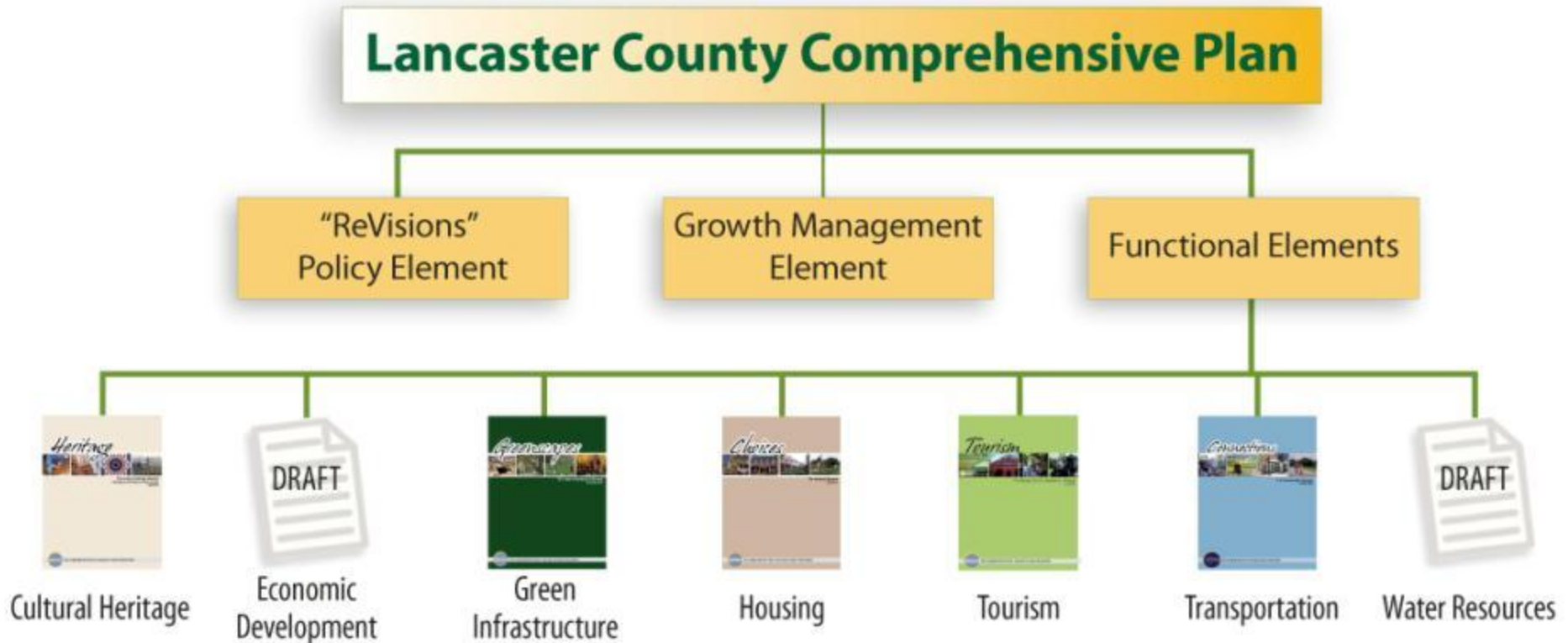
Making Places and Creating Destinations in Lancaster County

- 1 Lancaster County Tourism Plan**
- 2 Tourism Development Areas (TDAs)**
- 3 Implementation Tools**

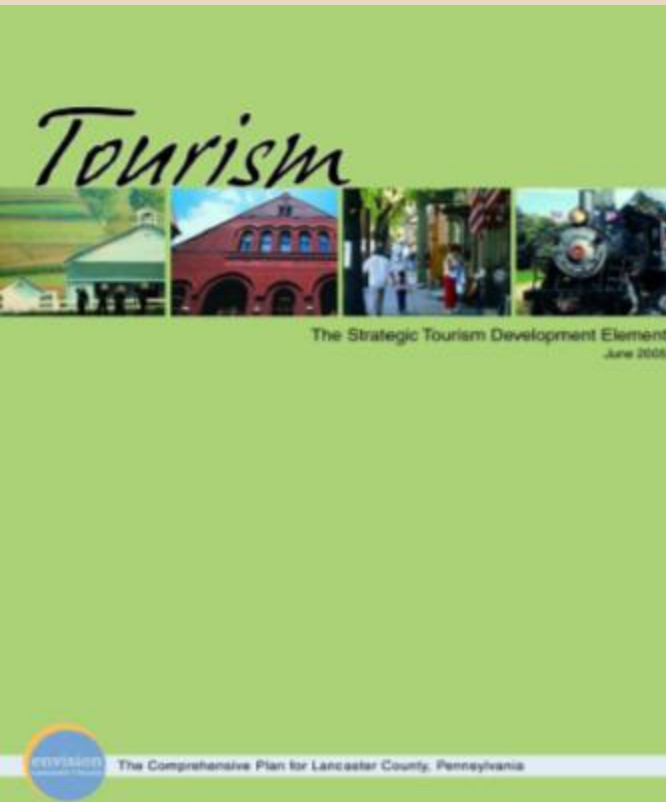
Background: Lancaster County Tourism Plan



Background



Background



The Lancaster County Tourism Plan calls for preserving and enhancing the county's authentic resources and sense of place as the foundation for future tourism development.

It also focuses on places with the greatest potential for tourism – the county's Tourism Development Areas (TDAs).

Tourism Development Areas (TDAs)



Characteristics



All TDAs have:

- A critical mass of attractions, services, and infrastructure – or the *potential* to develop them.
- Local support for tourism management and development.

Two Types:

- Urban – Within growth areas
- Rural – Agricultural and natural landscapes

Types of Urban TDAs



Primary – Tier 1

- Need continued enhancement
(Lititz, Strasburg Region)



Primary – Tier 2

- Need reinvestment
(Route 30, Adamstown)



Secondary

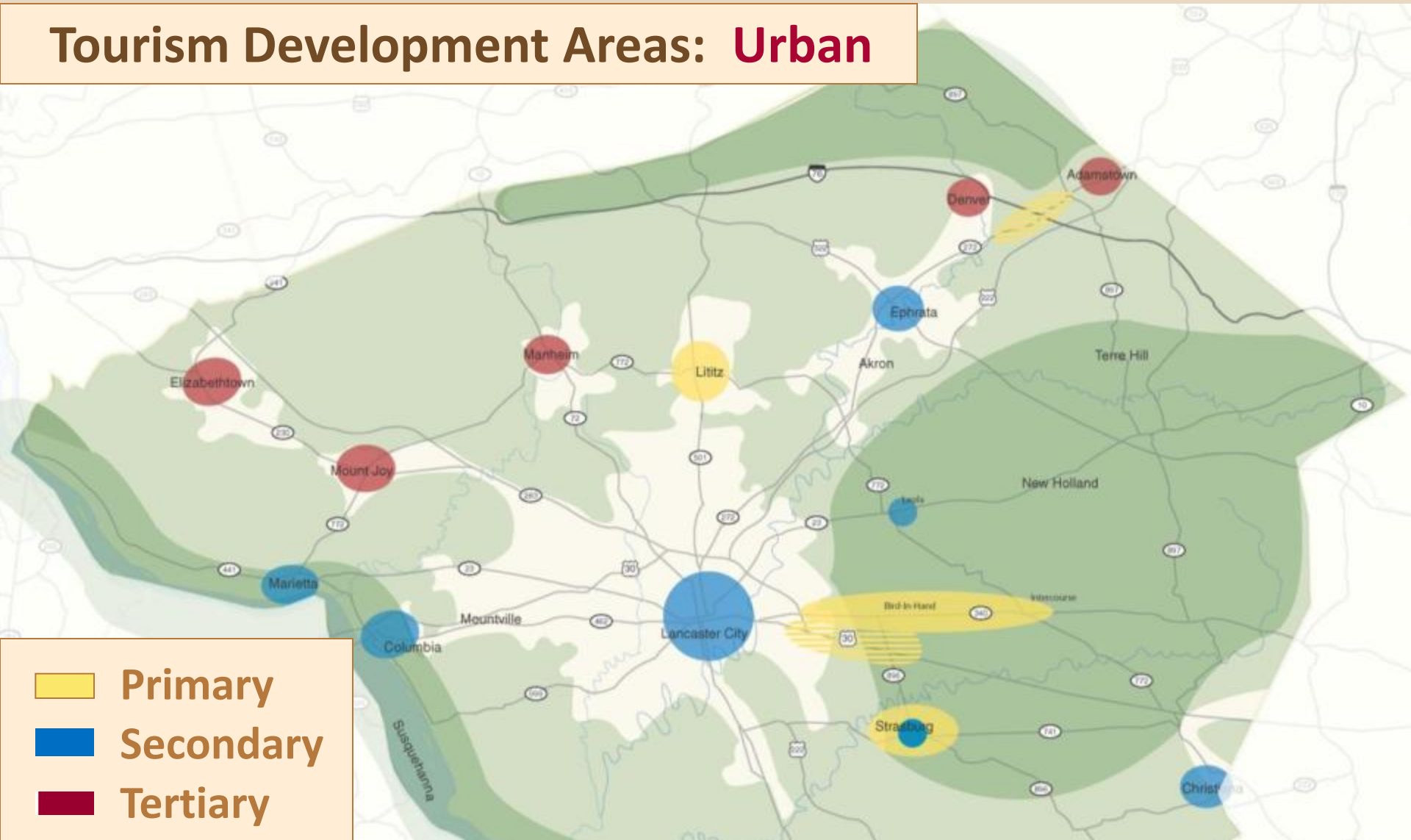
- Significant potential
(Lancaster, Ephrata, River Towns)



Tertiary

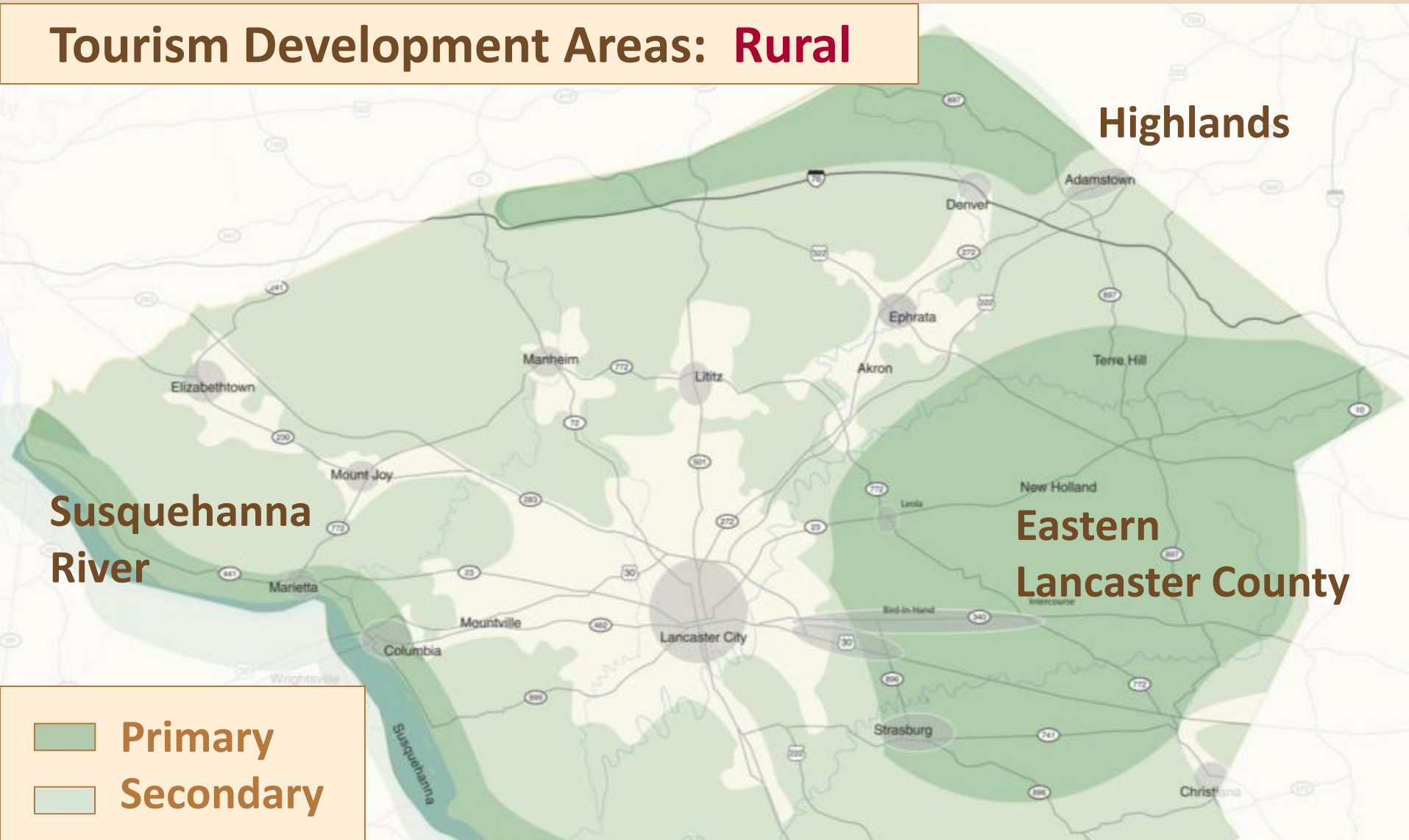
- Long-term potential
(E-town, Mount Joy, Manheim)

Tourism Development Areas: Urban



TDA's

Tourism Development Areas: Rural



Implementation Tools for TDAs



Tools



Management Structure

- Organize your stakeholders

Resource Assessment

- Survey your resources

Lancaster County Heritage Program

- Share your resources

Wayfinding

- Guide people to your resources

Management Structure

Organize Your Stakeholders



We'd like each TDA to create a local group representing all three sectors of the community:

- **Public – Municipal government**
- **Private – Residents, businesses, and institutions (schools, etc.)**
- **Nonprofit – Main Street organization or chamber of commerce**

Management Structure

Example:

Lincoln Highway Stakeholders



Public

**Local residents, East Lampeter,
LCPC, PennDOT**

Private

Major businesses:

**Dutch Wonderland, Tanger,
Rockvale, Host, Music Theatre**

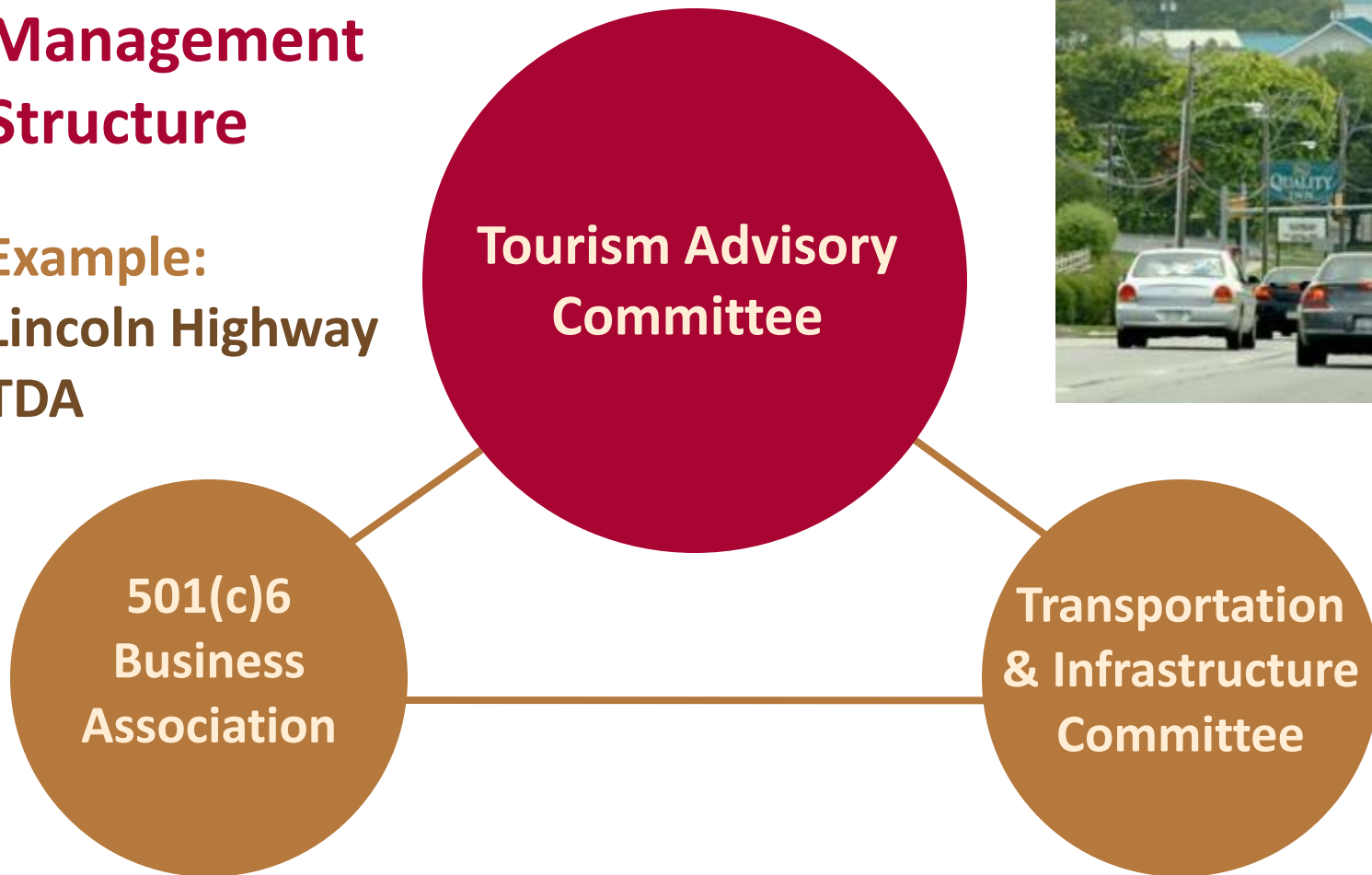
Nonprofit

**Lancaster Mennonite School,
PA Dutch CVB, James Street
Improvement District**

Management Structure

Establish a Formal Management Structure

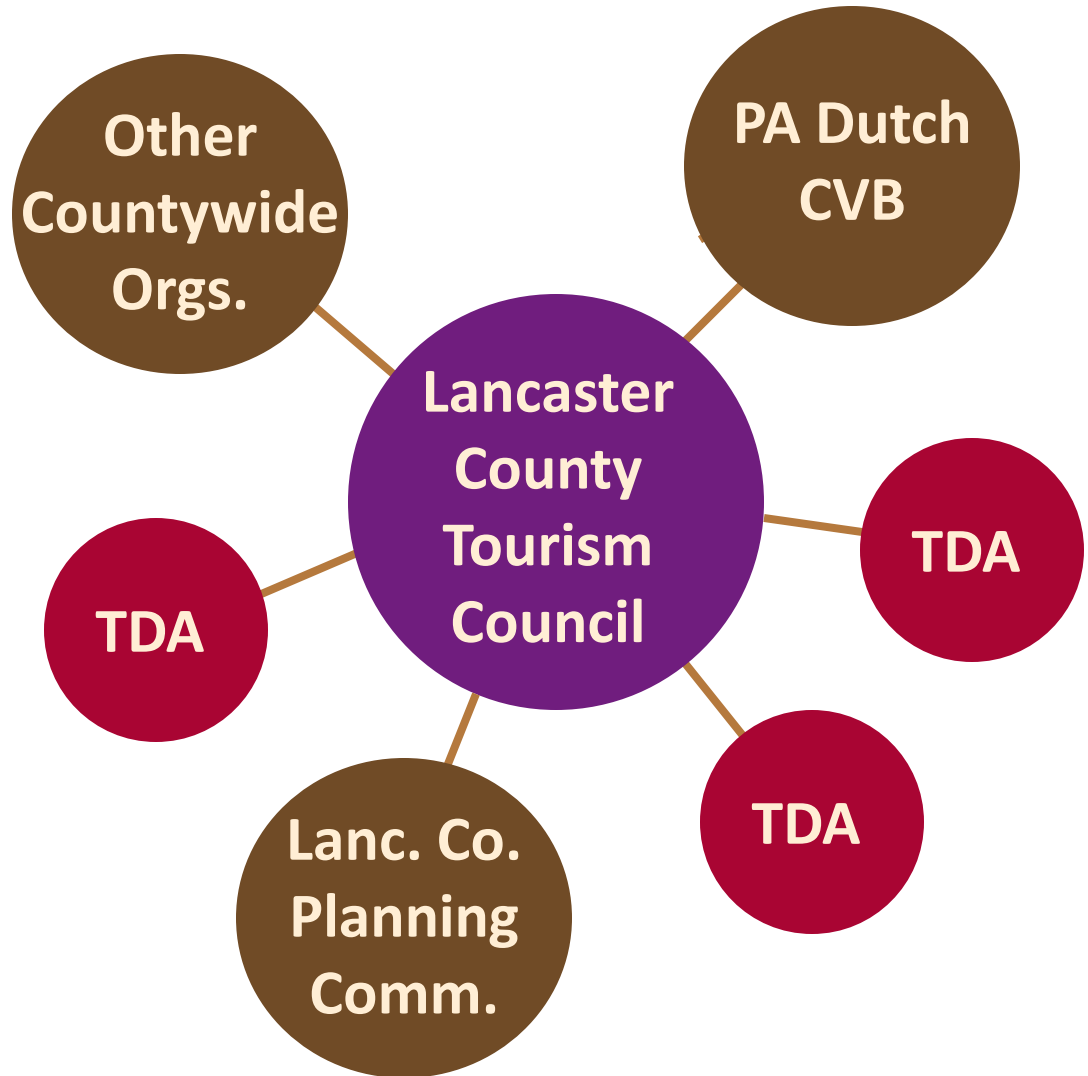
Example:
Lincoln Highway
TDA



Management Structure

Future Coordination

TDA's and countywide organizations



Resource Assessment

Survey Your Community

Consider:

- **Resources**
Natural, historic, and cultural
- **Attractions**
Regularly open to the public
- **Visitor services**
Lodging, dining, information
- **Interpretation**
Your community's "stories"



Resource Assessment

Historic Resource Inventory



The county is funding an historic resource inventory in 14 boroughs, because:

- Historic buildings are one of the most important resources in our boroughs, and
- Historic resource data for many of these communities is 20 to 30 years old.

Resource Assessment

Scope and Funding

Adamstown, Ephrata, Lititz, and Millersville are not being surveyed, because they have more recent data.

The project is funded by a grant resulting from Lancaster County's designation as a "Preserve America Community" in 2007.



Resource Assessment

Timeline

Jan. 2009 – County receives grant; surveyed boroughs are asked to provide \$1,000 in-kind match. Project kickoff delayed several months as new administration reviews funding for the program.

April 2010 – County receives grant agreement and begins work.

Sept. 2010 – Historic York contracted as consultant.

Nov. 2010 – Surveying begins.

Jan. 2011 – Marietta survey complete; Mountville next.



Resource Assessment

End Result

The consultant and County staff will create a publicly accessible online database that municipalities can edit.

Survey data can be used as a foundation for:

- Municipal ordinances
- Facade improvement programs
- Design guidelines



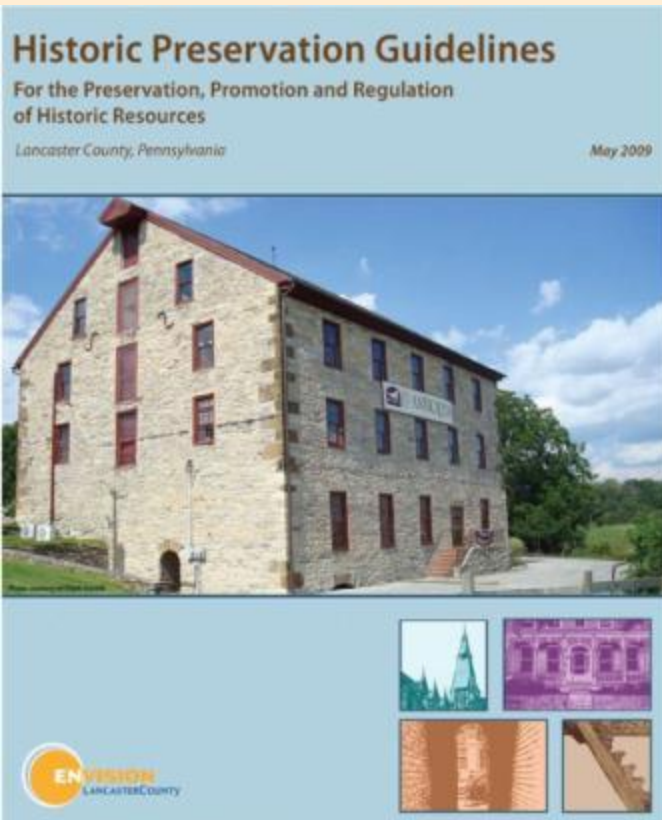
Resource Assessment

Preservation Guidelines

LCPC has also developed historic preservation guidelines for municipalities.

These guidelines discuss ordinances, demolition review, adaptive reuse, and other preservation issues.

www.co.lancaster.pa.us/toolbox



Other Tools



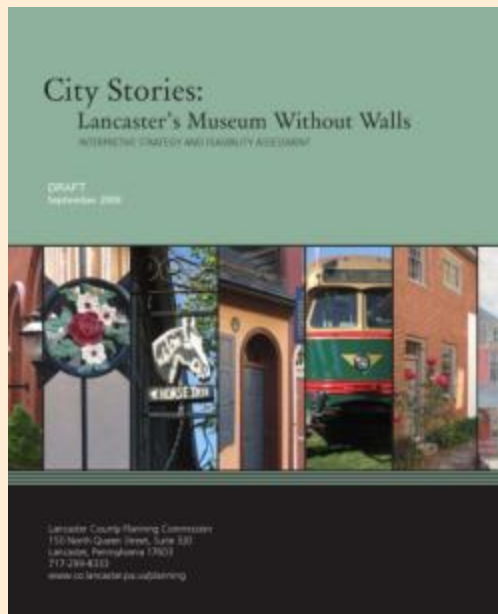
Resource Assessment

Strategic Plan

- Assess your tourism infrastructure – visitor services and attractions

Interpretation Plan

- Coordinate interpretation
- Support product development and partnerships focusing on heritage



Lancaster County Heritage



Highlights natural, cultural, and historic resources that authentically reflect the county's heritage.

Participants must meet criteria for authenticity, interpretation, and visitor readiness.



Heritage Program

Heritage Crafts

Display at County Building



Springerle Cookies



HERITAGE CRAFT

Springerle cookies, a centuries-old tradition from southern Germany, are made with eggs, flour, sugar, anise, and hartshorn (ammonium carbonate, a leavening agent). Springerle are known for their intricate designs imparted using hand-carved molds or specialized rolling pins.

While springerle designs originated in Bavarian winter festivals, the images later depicted natural and biblical scenes. Parents used these images as a way of telling stories to their children. German settlers brought the springerle tradition to Lancaster County. Although the cookies were once made year-round, they are more often associated with the Christmas season today.



Meet the Craftsperson:

Heather Botchlet



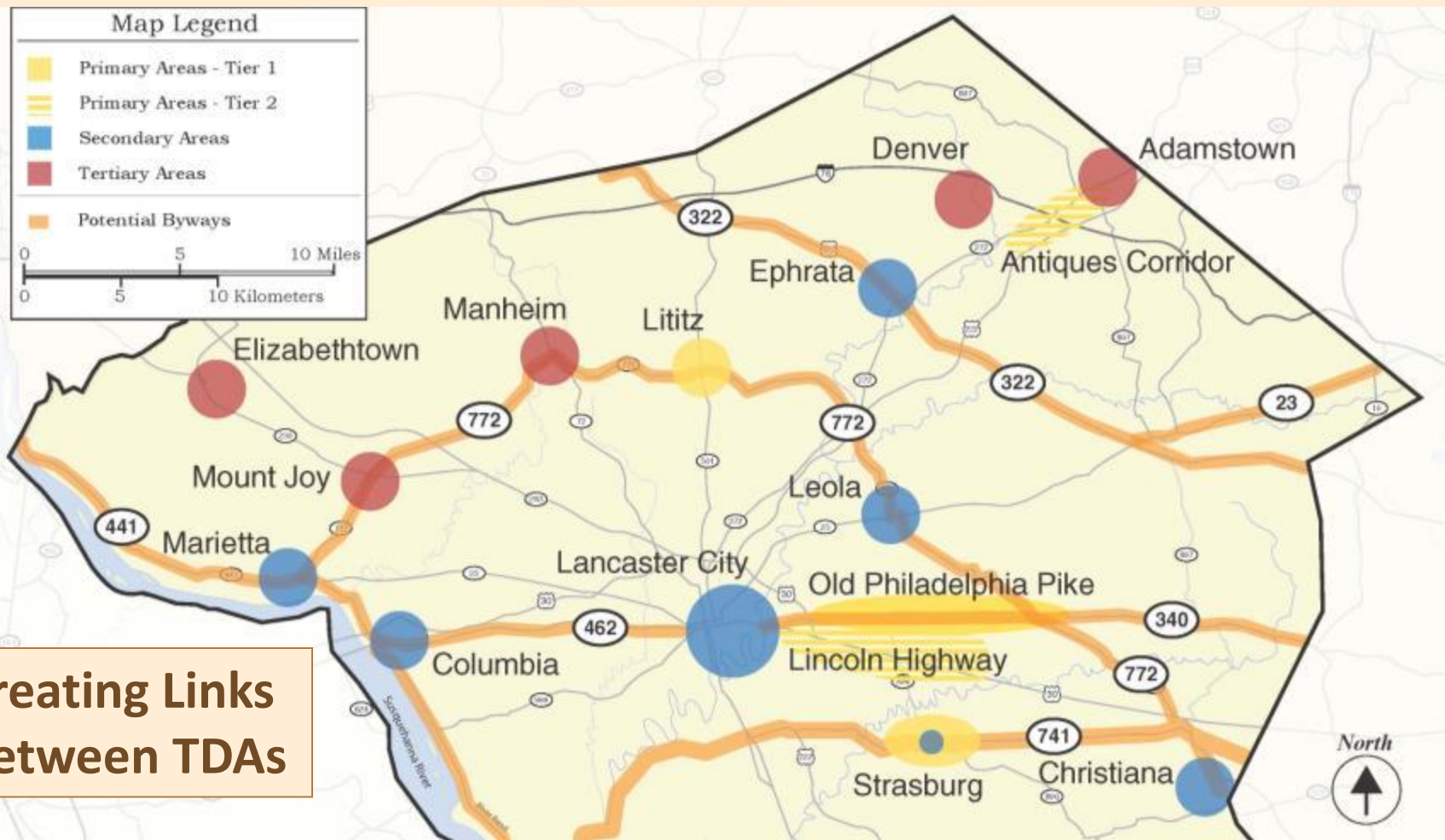
Heather is a fourth-generation springerle baker from Strasburg, Lancaster County. She first learned to make springerle from her mother. When Heather later began sending these cookies to relatives, she recognized the potential to create a springerle bakery. Today, she sells her cookies at her stand in Lancaster Central Market and at her tea shop in Strasburg, where she hosts demonstrations and lectures.

The Springerle House
15 East Main Street
Strasburg, Pennsylvania 17579
(and at Lancaster Central
Market, Penn Square, Lancaster)

Techniques and Materials
Heather still makes springerle by hand using an old family recipe. In addition to the traditional anise flavor, Heather offers them in other flavors including lemon, orange, vanilla, and chocolate.

Heritage Program

Heritage Byways



**Creating Links
between TDAs**

Heritage Byways

Heritage Program

Routes Under Study

Route 23

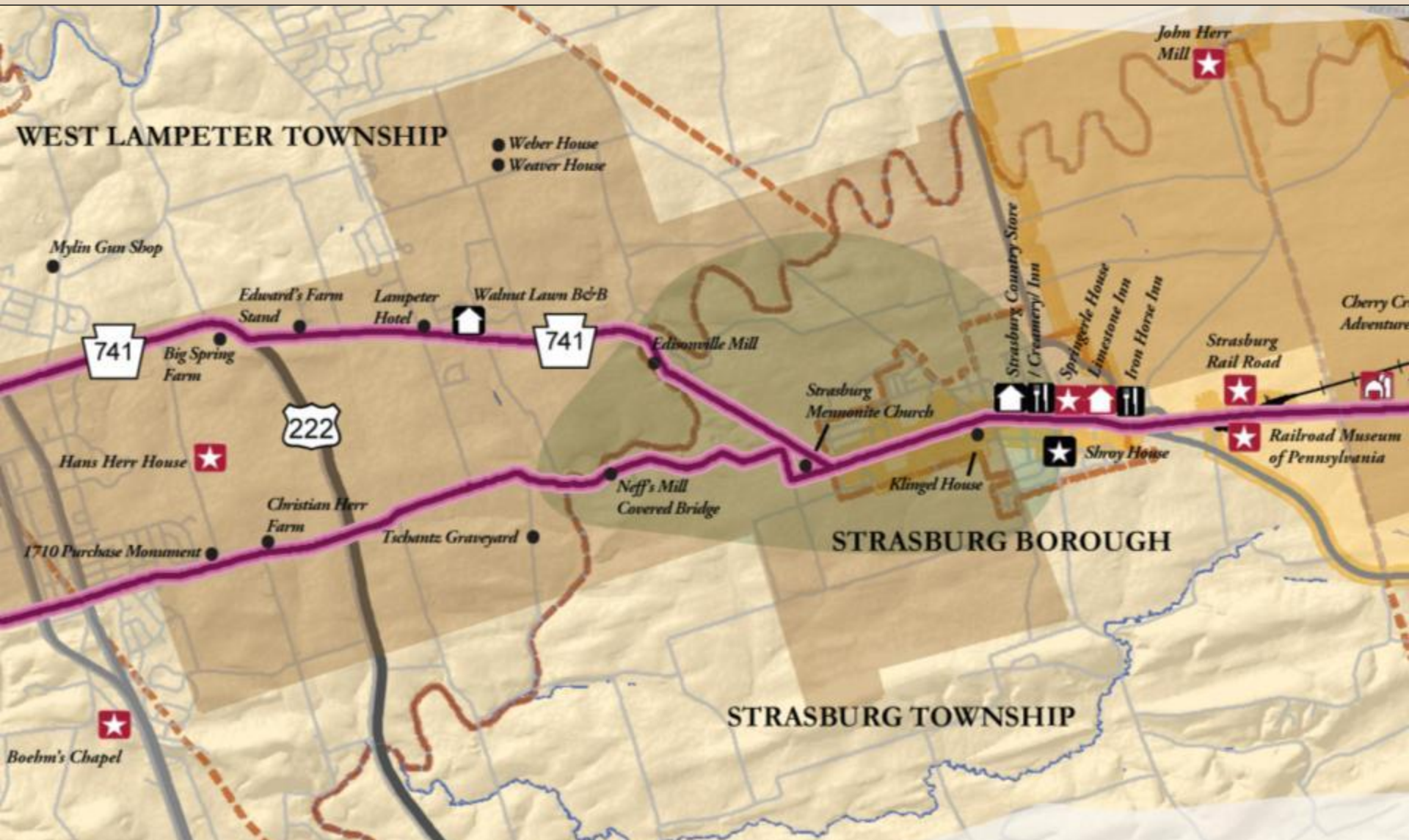
Old Philadelphia Pike

Old Conestoga Road



Heritage Byways

Heritage Program



Heritage Program

Towns & Villages Website



Historic Towns & Villages of LANCASTER COUNTY PENNSYLVANIA

[Home](#) | [About Us](#) | [Map of Lancaster County](#)

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[Themes & Stories](#)

[Events Calendar](#)



Manheim

The Towns & Villages of Lancaster County, Pennsylvania are a pleasant surprise to many visitors. When people think of Lancaster County, they often picture the Amish, scenic farmland, quilts and crafts, baked goods, and farm-fresh produce. But as memorable as these images are, they're just a part of what makes Lancaster County a special place.

From the front porches of Lititz and Ephrata, to the tree-lined streets of Strasburg, to Columbia and Marietta along the Susquehanna River, all

Lancaster County

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Towns & Villages

Lorem ipsum dolor sit amet, consectetur adipiscing elit. Fusce ut est. Cras tempus justo ut tortor. Integer arcu. Quisque pede. Nunc sapien.

Heritage Program

Heritage Communities

Municipalities that protect resources and share them in a sustainable way will be eligible for this designation.



Heritage Program

Heritage Ambassadors



We want the program to be truly representative of heritage attractions and services throughout the county – especially within TDAs.

So we'd like each TDA to identify potential participants and introduce them to the program.

To do that, we need a single point of contact for each TDA – a Heritage Ambassador.

Wayfinding



What is wayfinding?

Signs and other tools that orient people to their surroundings and guide them to specific destinations.

Wayfinding

Our Goal



Implement a countywide wayfinding system with:

- Vehicular signs that guide people to our TDAs,
- Vehicular signs that guide them to parking and attractions within TDAs, and
- Pedestrian signs that guide them on foot.

Wayfinding



Vehicular wayfinding signs on state routes are regulated by:

- **PennDOT – Because they affect traffic control and safety, and**
- **DCED – Because they’re a tool for tourism promotion.**

Pedestrian wayfinding signs are not regulated by the state, as long as they’re outside PennDOT rights of way.

Wayfinding

The Challenge

We wanted to implement a vehicular wayfinding system for Lancaster and York Counties, but the state chose to implement its own system.

Unfortunately, this system limits the ability of local communities to brand themselves as destinations.



Wayfinding

Compromise

In response, we negotiated a compromise with state agencies.

This approach maintains some regional consistency on vehicular signs, but still allows TDAs to highlight their own identity.



Wayfinding

Two-Track Solution



Vehicular Signs Outside TDAs

The state will install signs featuring the “Dutch Country Roads” brand.

Vehicular Signs Within TDAs

Municipalities can create “local signage districts” that allow them to brand their own signs.

Wayfinding

Vehicular Signs Outside TDAs

Old System

Tourism-Oriented Destination Signs (TODs)



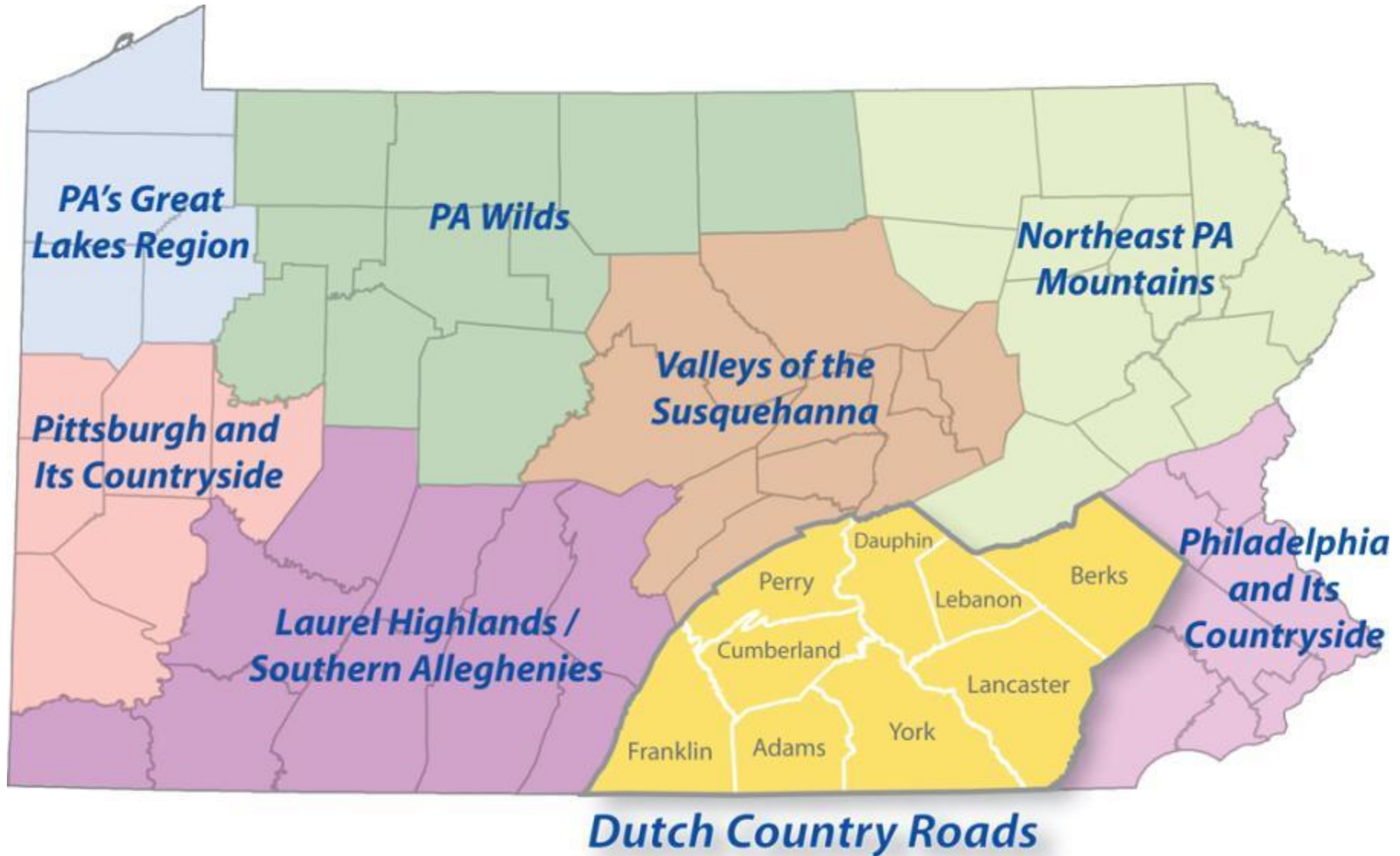
New System

Regional Wayfinding Signage



Pennsylvania Tourism Regions

Wayfinding



State System



- Pay to play – no statewide plan
- State is only paying for state parks (and possibly state museums) to be mentioned
- A consultant (PA Logos LLC, working under the PA Tourism Signing Trust) is managing the program
- Sign mentions scheduled to go on sale this spring

Working with the State System

The state system isn't what we wanted, but we can still use it to highlight the county's TDAs.

The state won't do it for us, but with your cooperation, we can make it happen.



TDA “Mentions” on State Signs



Our Proposal

Each TDA buys “group mentions” highlighting their community as a whole (for instance, Historic Ephrata, Downtown Lititz, etc.).

These mentions would appear on vehicular wayfinding signs posted along state routes leading into the community.

Vehicular Signs Outside TDAs

Wayfinding

Examples

TDA gets top mention (if first to buy)

Individual attractions mentioned below



Benefits

Why should TDAs buy mentions?

- Identifies your community as a destination, and gives visitors a sense of arrival.
- “Group mentions” are more affordable for many businesses.
- If you buy the first mention, it will be listed at the top of the sign.



Funding

How can we pay for these mentions?

- Each TDA raises funds from local governments, organizations, and businesses
- LCPC seeks transportation funds and grant funds on a countywide basis



Costs



Application Fee

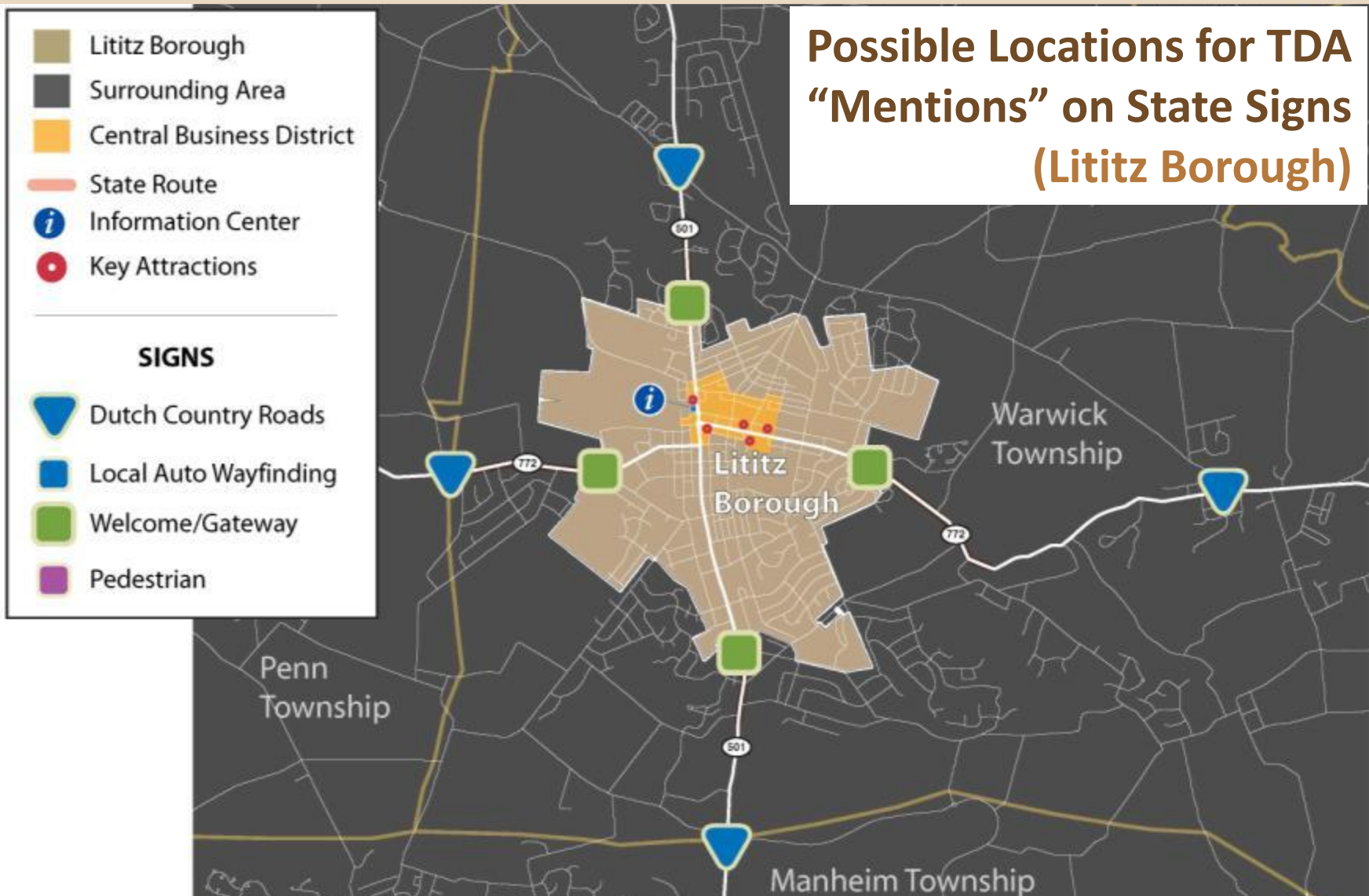
- \$75 per applicant (one-time fee)

Annual Fee (per mention)

- \$480 for 1 year or \$2,000 for 5 years (\$400 savings)
- Covers maintenance (including any damage), insurance, and program administration. Participants not responsible for any additional costs.

Sign Placement

Wayfinding



Sign Placement

Signs for most attractions will be placed at the next state highway intersection.

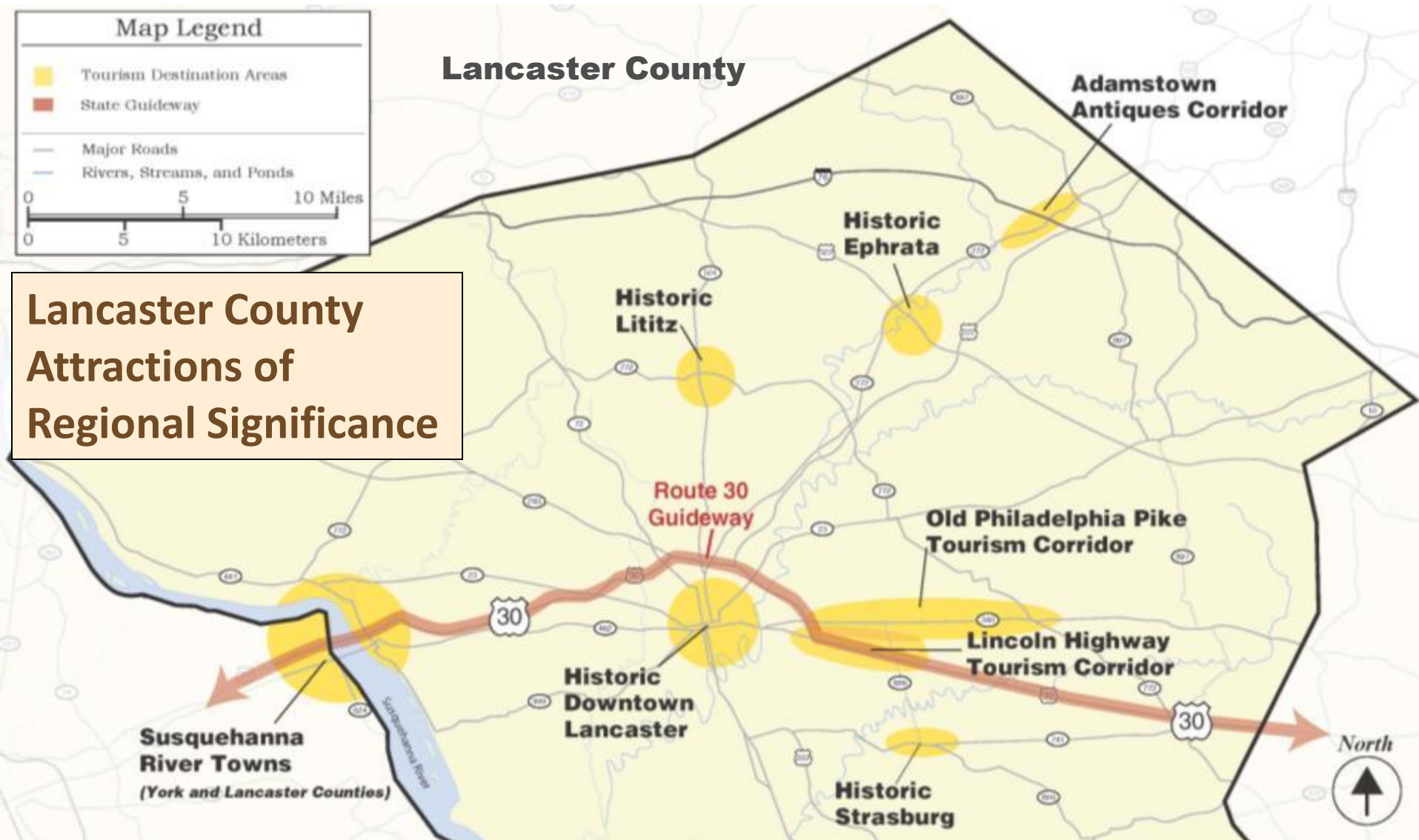
However, DCED asks each county to identify a few “Attractions of Regional Significance.” These destinations can be mentioned further away.

We worked with the visitors bureau to give this status to the county’s primary and secondary TDAs.



Vehicular Signs Outside TDAs

Wayfinding



Wayfinding

Gateway Signs

- Should be placed at entrances to your community – but not necessarily at the municipal boundary!
- Not regulated by PennDOT if outside its right-of-way
- Generally include some landscaping



Wayfinding

Vehicular Signs Within TDAs



To implement locally branded vehicular signs, a municipality must:

- Be located within a TDA
- Create a local signage district
- Complete a wayfinding plan with LCPC involvement
- Follow sign design guidelines established by LCPC and PennDOT

Local Signage Districts

Pros

- Signs feature the local “brand” – not the “Dutch Country Roads” regional brand.
- Municipality controls where wayfinding signs are placed.

Cons

- Municipality is responsible for all costs related to the signs – but can establish a fee structure to offset these costs.

Creating a District



To do this, a municipality must sign an agreement with PennDOT.

LCPC staff will facilitate this process, but we'd like to complete several agreements at the same time.

First, we need a resolution or letter of support from your municipality.

Vehicular Signs Within TDAs

Wayfinding

 Primary  Secondary  Tertiary

 Adamstown Borough	 Lancaster Township
 Christiana Borough	 Leacock Township
 Columbia Borough	 Lititz Borough
 Denver Borough	 Manheim Borough
 East Cocalico Township	 Marietta Borough
 East Lampeter Township	 Mount Joy Borough
 Elizabethtown Borough	 Strasburg Borough
 Ephrata Borough	 Strasburg Township
 Lancaster City	 Upper Leacock Township

Wayfinding

Vehicular and Pedestrian Wayfinding

Lancaster County, Pennsylvania



Lancaster County Planning Commission



Local Wayfinding Plans

If you create a local signage district, it's important to complete a plan that addresses both vehicular and pedestrian signage.

LCPC staff can help municipalities:

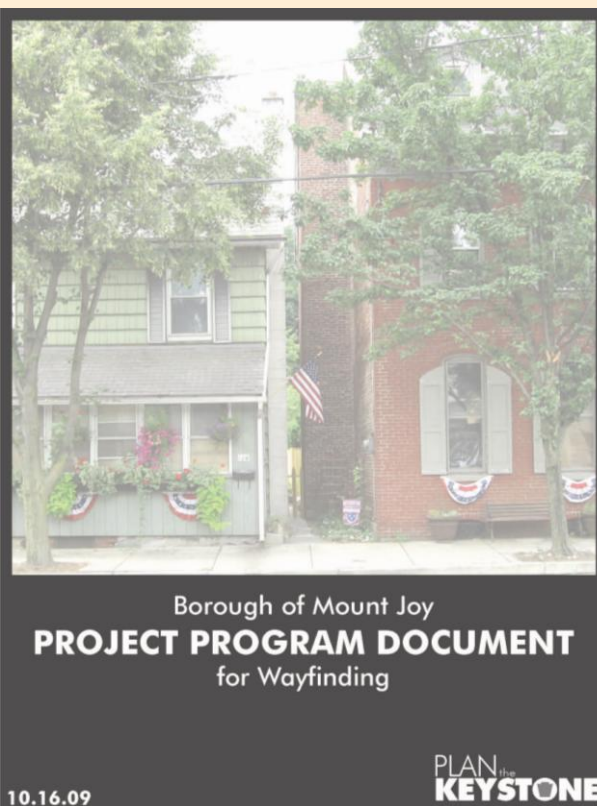
- Draft an RFP and choose a consultant
- Manage the planning process

Local Wayfinding Plans

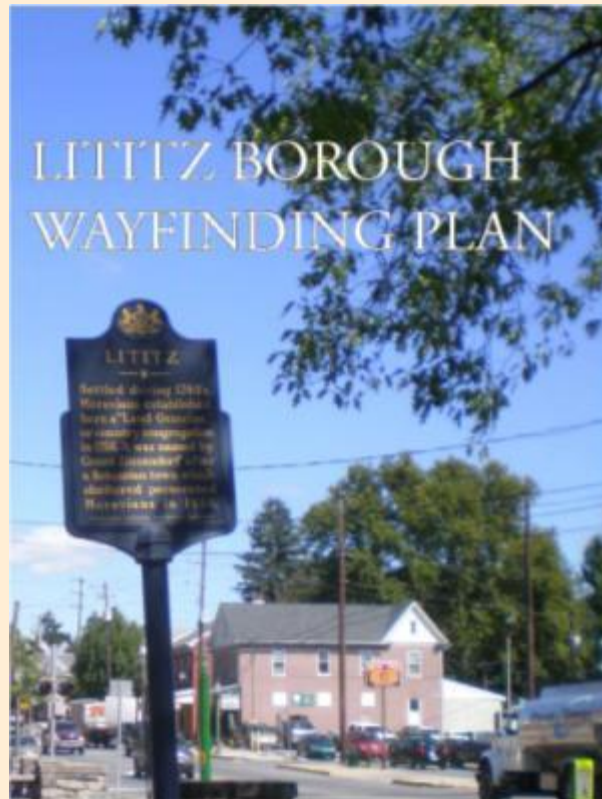
Wayfinding

Examples

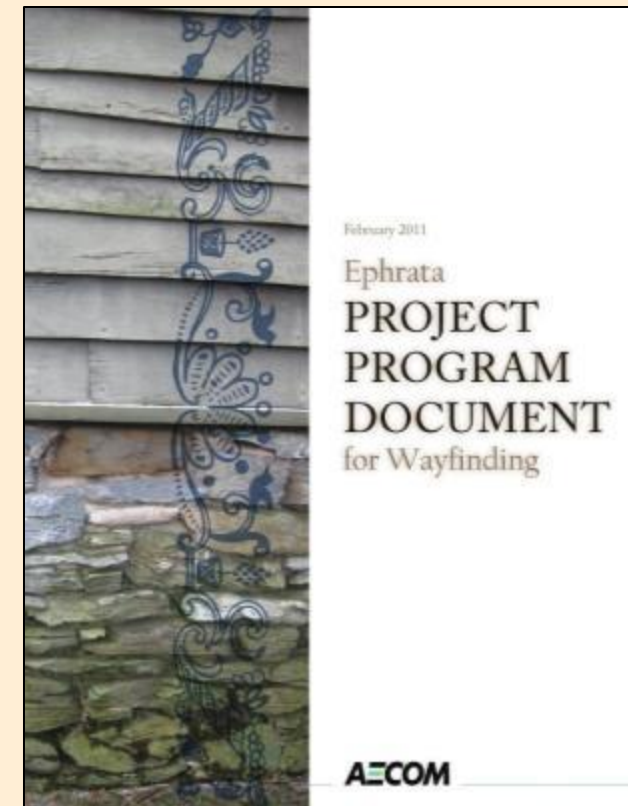
Mount Joy Borough



Lititz Borough



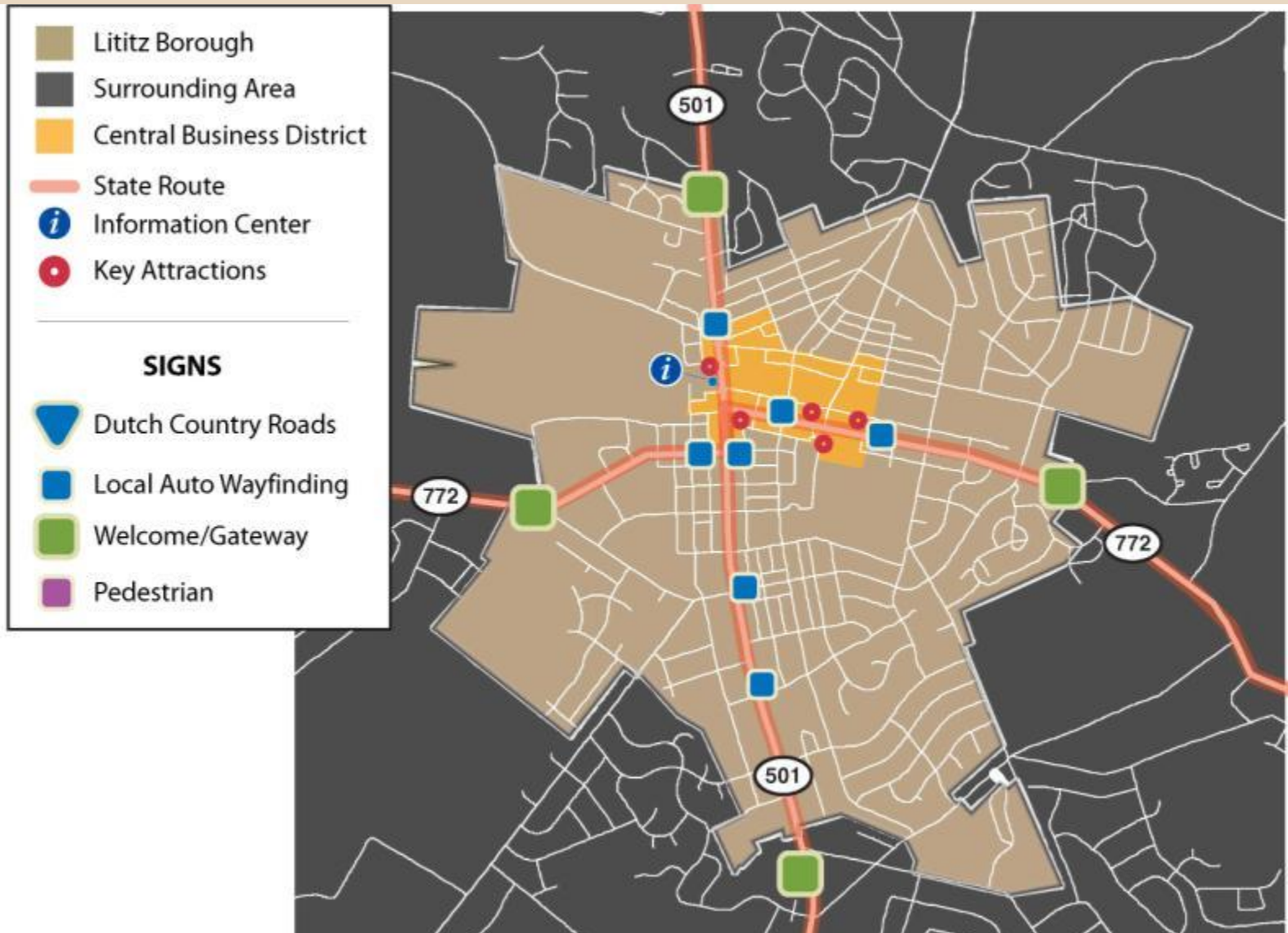
Ephrata Borough



Local Wayfinding Plans

Example: Lititz Borough

Wayfinding



Local Wayfinding Plans

Example: Lititz Borough

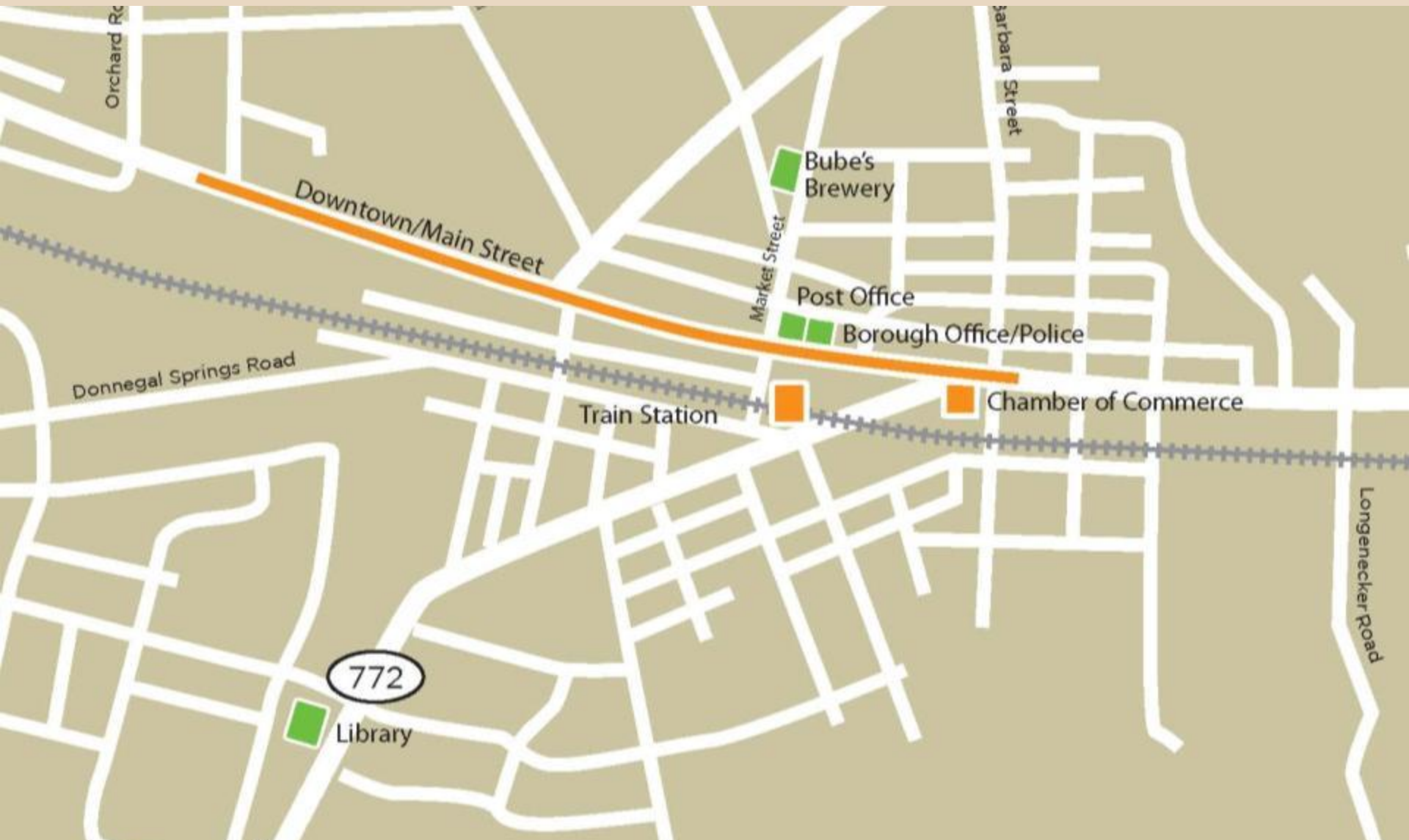
Wayfinding



Local Wayfinding Plans

Example: Mount Joy Borough

Wayfinding



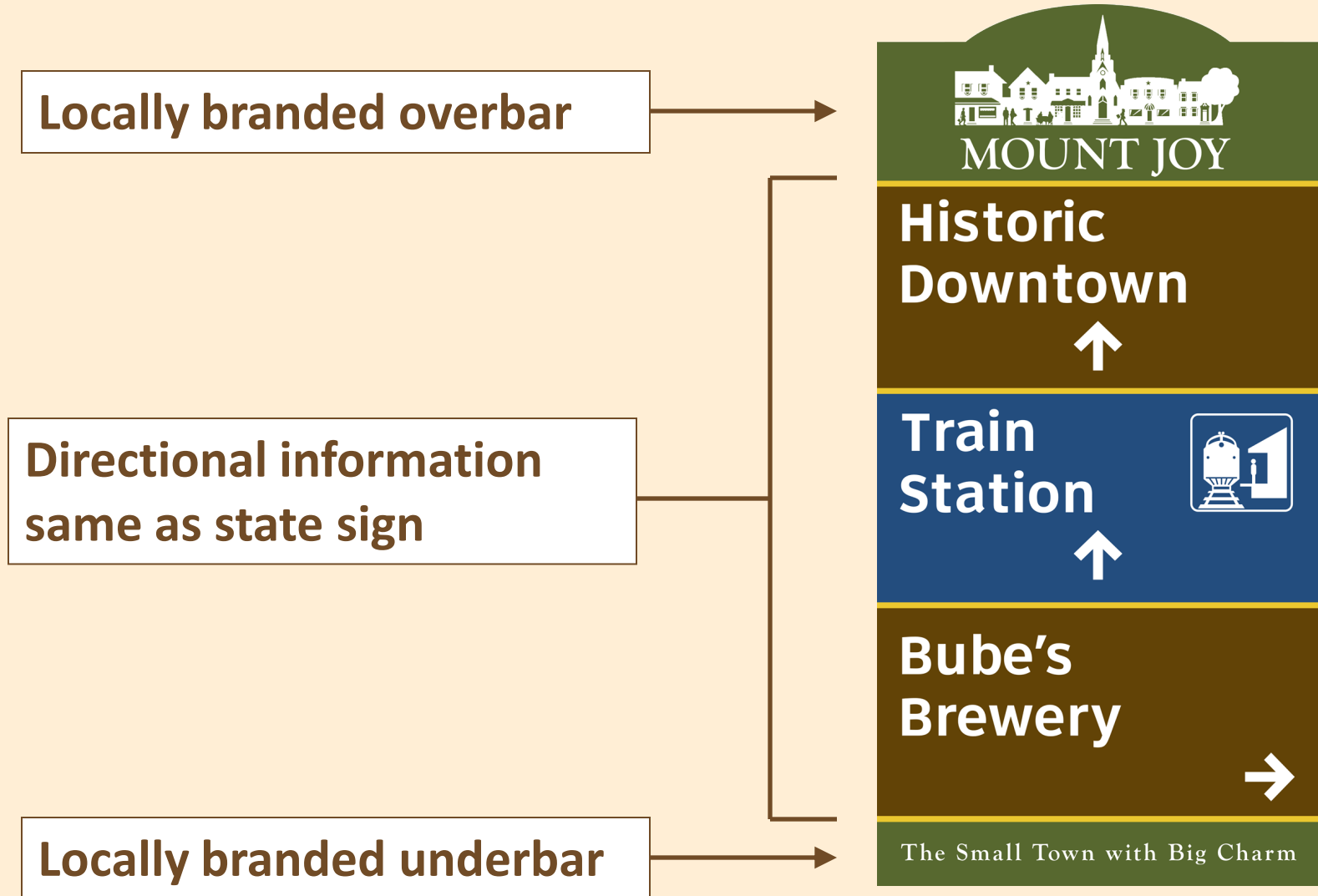


Design Guidelines

- Directional part of signs must match state system (colors, fonts, arrows, etc.)
- Locally branded “overbars” and “underbars” must meet PennDOT and LCPC requirements

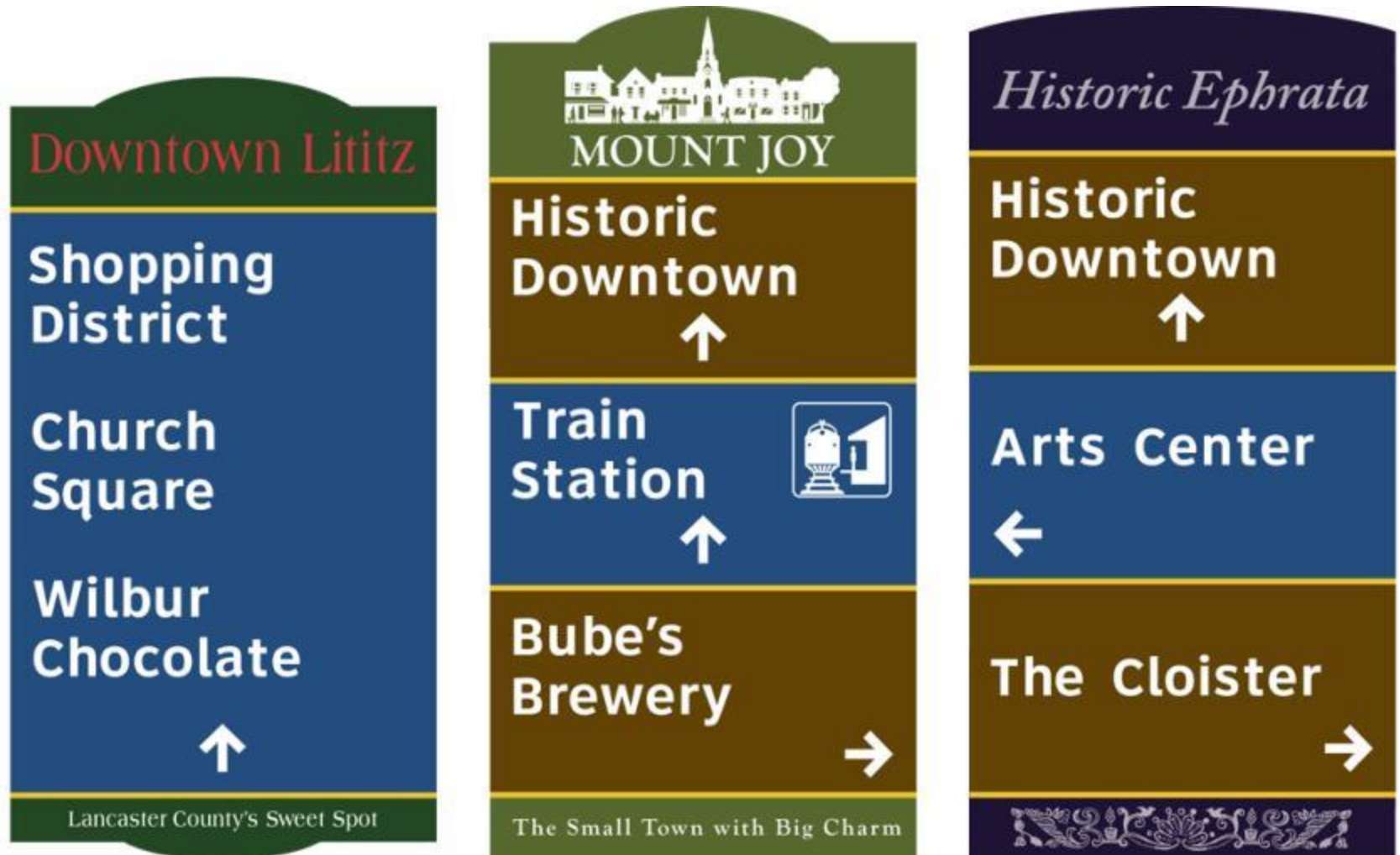
Vehicular Signs Within TDAs

Wayfinding



Vehicular Signs Within TDAs

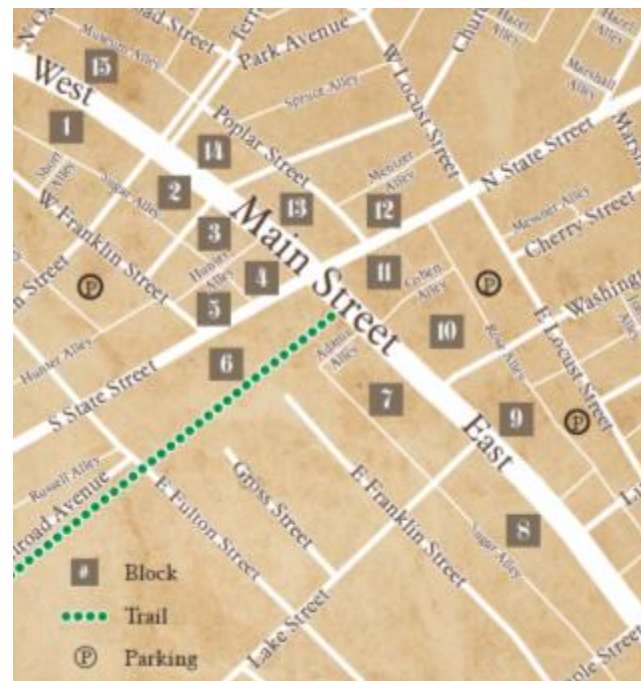
Wayfinding



Wayfinding

Pedestrian Signage

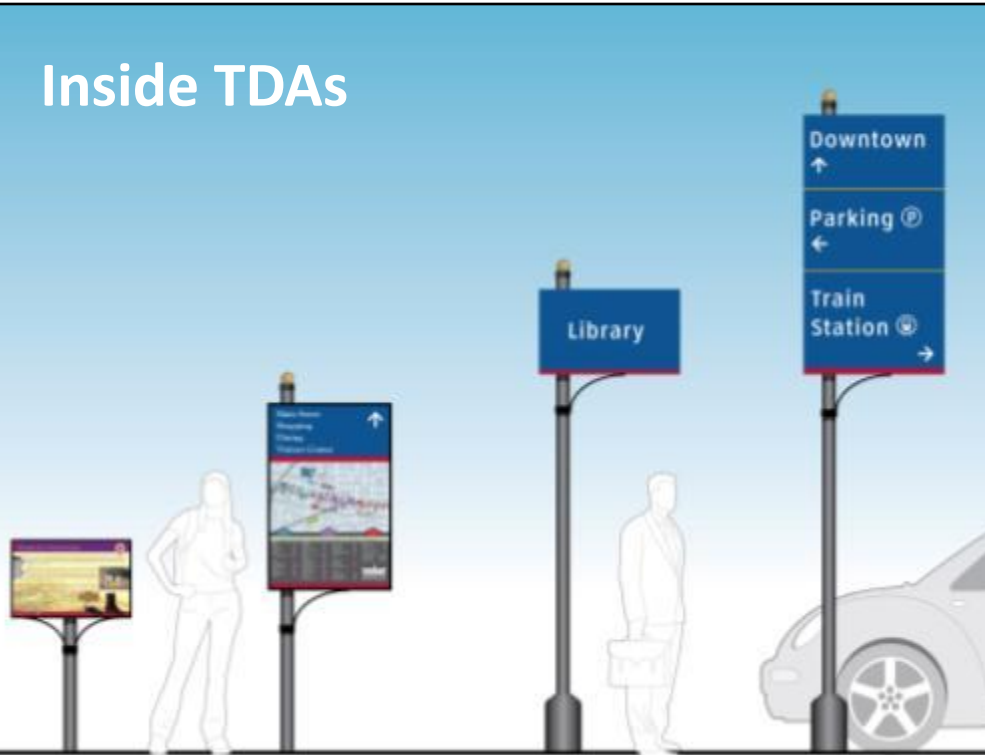
The design of these signs should match the branding on local vehicular signage within your TDA.



Vehicular and Pedestrian Signs: Mount Joy Sign “Palette”

Wayfinding

Inside TDAs

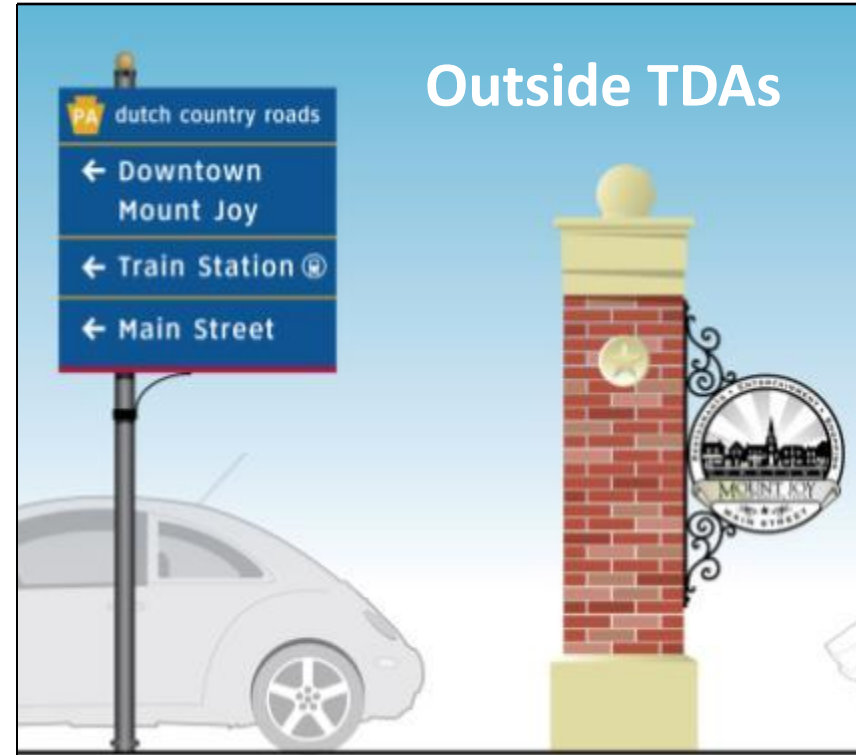


Interp.

Pedestrian

Local
Vehicular

Outside TDAs



Regional
Vehicular

Gateway

Vehicular and Pedestrian Signs: Ephrata Sign “Palette”

Wayfinding

Inside TDAs



Pedestrian

Banner
Parking

Local
Vehicular

Outside TDAs



Regional
Vehicular

Next Steps



Next Steps



What you can do to help:

- **Create a management structure in your TDA**
- **Assess local resources, attractions, services, and interpretation**
- **Work with LCPC to create a signage district in your municipality**
- **Choose a “Heritage Ambassador” and provide information for Towns & Villages website**